

Brazilian Churrasco

"Fire, salt, and the art of the skewer — where every cut tells a story."

42 SEATS	\$48 AVG SPEND	24% FOOD COST TARGET	\$29K EST. MONTHLY NET
-------------	-------------------	-------------------------	---------------------------

CONFIDENTIAL — KITCHEN & MANAGEMENT USE ONLY
Brazilian Churrasco Restaurant Group · All Rights Reserved

Chef's Lens

// THE PHILOSOPHY OF CHURRASCO

Brazilian churrasco is not a technique — it is a ceremony. The churrasceiro is not merely a cook; they are a keeper of fire, a sculptor of smoke, and a guardian of tradition stretching back centuries to the gauchos of Rio Grande do Sul. Each cut of meat tells a different story: the rich marbling of picanha, the slow-rendered tenderness of costela, the snap of linguiça skin over open flame.

This guide exists to protect that story. Every prep time, every temperature guide, every service script is in service of one goal: when a guest sits at your table, they should feel they are in Brazil — not a facsimile of it.

Fire is your primary ingredient. Respect it. Learn it. Master it. Everything else follows.

— **Execute with intention. Every plate is a performance.**

// CORE OPERATIONAL PRINCIPLES

1. Fire First: The churrasco fire must be started 90 minutes before service. Hardwood charcoal only — no lighter fluid, ever.

2. Salt Discipline: Picanha takes coarse rock salt only. Applied at skewer, not marinade. Shaken off before service.

3. Costela Commitment: Short ribs enter the slow cooker at 09:00 without exception. 7-hour cook is non-negotiable.

4. The Skewer Technique: Hold skewer vertically at table height. Slice thin against the grain directly onto guest's plate. Control the pour — guests signal with palm-down (stop) or palm-up (more).

5. Feijoada Fridays: Begin feijoada by 11:00. It cannot be rushed. Pre-sell begins Thursday evening service.

Section 1 — Entrées

Pão de Queijo — Brazilian Cheese Bread

PREP: 18 min | FC: 12% | ALLERGENS: Dairy · Gluten-Free (tapioca)

Item	Qty	Unit Cost	Total
Tapioca flour	200g	\$0.18/100g	\$0.36
Minas cheese (or parmesan)	80g	\$0.60/100g	\$0.48
Whole eggs	2	\$0.25 ea	\$0.50
Whole milk	60ml	\$0.08/100ml	\$0.05
Butter + rock salt	30g / pinch	\$0.20/30g	\$0.20

12%

\$13.50

\$1.59

\$11.91

FOOD COSTSELL PRICEINGREDIENT COSTGROSS MARGIN

- 1

Combine tapioca flour, salt, and butter in a mixing bowl. Blend until crumbly.
- 2

Warm milk to

70°C

 and pour over flour mixture. Mix vigorously until dough forms.
- 3

Add eggs one at a time, then fold in grated cheese. Rest dough 5 minutes.
- 4

Roll into 30g balls. Bake at

200°C

 for 15–18 minutes until golden and puffed.
- 5

Serve immediately in a lined basket — they deflate within 4 minutes of coming out.

Chef's Tip: Double-batch the dough in the morning and refrigerate unbaked balls. Fire to order for table-fresh delivery every service.

Coxinha — Chicken Croquette

PREP: 6 min (from pre-formed) | FC: 17% | ALLERGENS: Gluten · Dairy · Chicken

Item	Qty	Unit Cost	Total
Shredded chicken (catupiry blend)	80g	\$0.55/100g	\$0.44
Wheat flour dough (pre-batch)	100g	\$0.12/100g	\$0.12
Catupiry cream cheese	20g	\$0.90/100g	\$0.18
Breadcrumbs + egg wash	30g / 1 egg	\$0.10 / \$0.25	\$0.35
Frying oil (per portion)	50ml	\$0.06/100ml	\$0.03

17%

\$13.00

\$1.12

\$11.88

FOOD COSTSELL PRICEINGREDIENT COSTGROSS MARGIN

- 1

Pull pre-formed coxinha from refrigerated mise en place. Verify shape integrity.
- 2

Dip in egg wash, then roll firmly in fine breadcrumbs. Double-coat for extra crunch.
- 3

Fry at

175°C

 for 4–5 minutes until deep golden brown.
- 4

Drain on wire rack for 60 seconds. Plate on banana leaf liner with lime wedge.

Chef's Tip: Form coxinha in bulk during morning prep. Refrigerate on trays lined with parchment — they hold 48 hours raw, ready to fry to order in under 6 minutes.

Bolinho de Bacalhau — Salt Cod Fritter

PREP: 5 min (from pre-formed) | FC: 20% | ALLERGENS: Fish · Gluten

20%	\$14.50	\$1.47	\$13.03
FOOD COST	SELL PRICE	INGREDIENT COST	GROSS MARGIN

- Chef's Tip:** Desalt cod in bulk Sunday evening for full-week supply. Never rush the soak — residual salt ruins the balance of the entire fritter.

Farofa — Toasted Cassava

PREP: 8 min | FC: 10% | ALLERGENS: None (check butter source for dairy)

10%	\$7.50	\$0.64	\$6.86
FOOD COST	SELL PRICE	INGREDIENT COST	GROSS MARGIN

- Chef's Tip:** Farofa is your highest-margin item at 10% FC. Push it as a table side — it pairs with everything and guests love the texture contrast.

Vinagrete

Vinagrete Salad

PREP: 5 min | FC: 9% | ALLERGENS: None

Item	Qty	Unit Cost	Total
Tomato (diced)	80g	\$0.30/100g	\$0.24
White onion (diced)	40g	\$0.15/100g	\$0.06
Green pepper (diced)	40g	\$0.25/100g	\$0.10
Red wine vinegar + olive oil	15ml / 10ml	\$0.05 / \$0.08	\$0.13
Parsley + salt	5g / pinch	misc	\$0.03

9%

\$7.00

\$0.56

\$6.44

FOOD COSTSELL PRICEINGREDIENT COSTGROSS MARGIN

1

Dice tomato, onion, and green pepper into fine, uniform 5mm cubes — precision matters here.

2

Combine in bowl. Season with salt and let sit 2 minutes to macerate.

3

Dress with red wine vinegar and olive oil. Toss with fresh parsley.

4

Serve immediately in a small ramekin alongside the meat spread.

Chef's Tip: Pre-batch vinagrete in the morning but hold the dressing. Dress per order to prevent sogginess — this is your second-highest margin entrée at 9% FC.

Coração de Frango

Coração de Frango — Chicken Hearts on Skewer

PREP: 8 min | FC: 14% | ALLERGENS: Poultry

Item	Qty	Unit Cost	Total
Chicken hearts (trimmed)	120g	\$0.85/100g	\$1.02
Rock salt	5g	\$0.02	\$0.02
Garlic + lime marinade	10g / 15ml	misc	\$0.08
Skewer (metal, reusable)	1	amortized	\$0.01

14%

\$11.50

\$1.13

\$10.37

FOOD COST SELL PRICE INGREDIENT COSTGROSS MARGIN

1

Trim hearts, remove any fat caps or connective tissue. Rinse cold and pat dry.

2

Marinate in garlic, lime, and salt for minimum 2 hours (overnight is better).

3

Thread 6–8 hearts per skewer, leaving slight gaps for even heat penetration.

4

Grill over high direct heat, 250°C+, 3–4 minutes per side until charred exterior, pink-tender interior.

5

Serve on skewer, tableside. Educate guests — this is a true gaucho staple.

Chef's Tip: Coração is the conversation starter. Brief servers to introduce it with confidence — "This is what every churrasco master eats first at the fire." Curiosity converts skeptics.

Section 2 — Mains

Picanha ★ Signature

Picanha — Top Sirloin Cap

PREP: 14 min | FC: 22% | SIGNATURE | ALLERGENS: Beef

Item	Qty	Unit Cost	Total
Picanha cap (trimmed, fat on)	300g	\$1.98/100g	\$5.94
Coarse rock salt	10g	\$0.01	\$0.01
Garlic butter (tableside finish)	10g	\$0.20	\$0.20

22% \$26.99 \$6.15 \$20.84

FOOD COST SELL PRICE INGREDIENT COSTGROSS MARGIN

- 1 Score fat cap in crosshatch pattern. Fold each piece into a C-shape with fat facing out and skewer through the fold.
- 2 Apply generous coat of coarse rock salt to fat cap only. No marinade — ever.
- 3 Grill fat-side first at 240°C for 5 minutes to render, then rotate every 3 minutes to desired doneness.
- 4 Rest skewer off fire for 2 minutes before tableside service.
- 5 At table: hold skewer vertically, slice thin against the grain. Let the fat run over the cut. The theatre is part of the dish.

Chef's Tip: Picanha is your identity dish. Never serve beyond medium — the fat becomes waxy at well-done. If a guest insists on well-done, politely educate: "The fat loses its flavour above medium. May I show you what we recommend?" Most guests will convert.

Fraldinha

Fraldinha — Flank Steak

PREP: 12 min | FC: 21% | ALLERGENS: Beef

Item	Qty	Unit Cost	Total
Flank steak (trimmed)	280g	\$1.75/100g	\$4.90
Chimichurri marinade	30ml	\$0.18/30ml	\$0.18
Rock salt + black pepper	8g / 2g	misc	\$0.05
Lime (garnish)	1/4	\$0.08	\$0.08

21% \$25.00 \$5.21 \$19.79

FOOD COST SELL PRICE INGREDIENT COSTGROSS MARGIN

- 1 Marinate fraldinha in chimichurri for minimum 4 hours. Overnight preferred for deeper penetration.
- 2 Pat dry before skewering — wet meat steams, not sears.
- 3 Grill at 220°C for 5–6 min per side for medium-rare. Rest 2 minutes off heat.
- 4 Slice thin against the grain in long diagonal cuts. Serve with chimichurri on the side.

Chef's Tip: Fraldinha has prominent grain — cutting with it makes it tough and chewy. Against the grain at a 45° angle is non-negotiable. Train every carver on this visually before service.

Costela★ Signature

Costela — Beef Short Rib

PREP: 7hr slow cook + 8 min grill | FC: 23% | SIGNATURE | ALLERGENS: Beef

Item	Qty	Unit Cost	Total
Beef short rib (bone-in)	400g raw	\$1.85/100g	\$7.40
Rock salt + coarse pepper	12g / 5g	misc	\$0.05
Garlic + bay leaf (braise)	3 cloves / 2	misc	\$0.10
Wood smoke chips	20g	\$0.15	\$0.15

23%

\$33.00

\$7.70

\$25.30

FOOD COST SELL PRICE INGREDIENT COSTGROSS MARGIN

1

09:00 sharp: season ribs generously with salt and pepper. Load into slow cooker with garlic and bay leaves at 120°C.

2

Cook 7 hours uncovered. The connective tissue must fully convert to gelatin — no shortcuts.

3

At service: rest ribs 15 min, then finish on live fire for 6–8 min with smoke chips for char and colour.

4

Portion bone-in, 1–2 ribs per serve. Present on wooden board tableside.

5

The meat should pull away with no resistance. If it doesn't, it's not ready. 30 more minutes — never rush costela.

Chef's Tip: Costela is your most talked-about dish. When it runs out, it's gone — build scarcity into your service narrative. "We only do 14 portions of costela each evening" creates anticipation and drives early orders.

Linguiça

Linguiça — Brazilian Pork Sausage

PREP: 10 min | FC: 18% | ALLERGENS: Pork

Item	Qty	Unit Cost	Total
Linguiça sausage (linked)	180g	\$1.40/100g	\$2.52
Mustard + bread (accompaniment)	15g / 1 slice	\$0.10 / \$0.15	\$0.25
Pickled onion garnish	20g	\$0.12/100g	\$0.02

18%

\$16.00

\$2.79

\$13.21

FOOD COST SELL PRICE INGREDIENT COSTGROSS MARGIN

1

Score sausage skins lightly — prevents burst and allows smoke penetration.

2

Grill over medium-high heat 200°C, turning every 2 minutes for even colour. Total 8–10 minutes.

3

Rest 1 minute. Slice on the bias into 4–5 thick coins per portion.

4

Plate with Brazilian mustard and fresh bread on the side.

Chef's Tip: Linguiça is the crowd-pleaser and volume driver. Push it to tables waiting for slow cuts — keeps energy up and prevents impatience while costela or cordeiro finishes.

Frango

Frango — Marinated Chicken Thigh

PREP: 16 min | FC: 17% | ALLERGENS: Poultry

Item	Qty	Unit Cost	Total
Chicken thigh (bone-in, skin-on)	220g	\$0.90/100g	\$1.98
Garlic + lemon + paprika marinade	30ml	\$0.20	\$0.20
Rock salt	5g	misc	\$0.02
Chimichurri drizzle	15ml	\$0.09	\$0.09

17%

\$19.50

\$2.29

\$17.21

FOOD COST SELL PRICE INGREDIENT COSTGROSS MARGIN

1

Marinate thighs in garlic-lemon-paprika blend overnight. Minimum 4 hours before service.

2

Skewer through bone to maintain shape on the grill. Apply additional salt to skin.

3

Grill skin-side first at

200°C

 for 8 minutes, flip, continue 6–8 minutes until internal

74°C

.

4

Rest 2 minutes. Drizzle chimichurri tableside.

Chef's Tip: Always verify internal temp — food safety non-negotiable with poultry. Keep an instant thermometer at the grill at all times during service.

Cordeiro + Premium

Cordeiro — Lamb Rack

PREP: 16 min | FC: 24% | PREMIUM | ALLERGENS: Lamb

Item	Qty	Unit Cost	Total
Lamb rack (frenched, 2 bones)	260g	\$3.50/100g	\$9.10
Rosemary + garlic crust	15g	\$0.25	\$0.25
Mint yogurt sauce	40ml	\$0.30	\$0.30
Rock salt + olive oil	5g / 10ml	misc	\$0.08

24%

\$41.00

\$9.73

\$31.27

FOOD COST SELL PRICE INGREDIENT COSTGROSS MARGIN

1

Rest lamb at room temperature 30 minutes before cooking. Cold meat on hot grill seizes.

2

Season with salt and olive oil. Press rosemary-garlic crust onto fat side.

3

Sear crust-side down at

250°C

 for 3 minutes, then grill bone-side 4 minutes per side for medium-rare.

4

Rest off heat 3 minutes. Internal target:

57°C

 for medium-rare.

5

Present on wooden board with mint yogurt sauce, dramatic bone-up.

Chef's Tip: Cordeiro is the table status dish. When a neighbouring table sees it go out bone-up, they order one. Carry it out high, visible, dramatic. Theatre sells it before the flavour does.

Salmão Grelhado

Salmão Grelhado — Grilled Salmon

PREP: 10 min | FC: 22% | ALLERGENS: Fish

Item	Qty	Unit Cost	Total
Salmon fillet (skin-on)	200g	\$2.80/100g	\$5.60
Lime + dill + olive oil	1/2 / 5g / 10ml	misc	\$0.20
Farofa crumble (side)	30g	\$0.22/100g	\$0.07
Rock salt + white pepper	5g / 2g	misc	\$0.03

22%

\$26.50

\$5.90

\$20.60

FOOD COSTSELL PRICEINGREDIENT COSTGROSS MARGIN

1

Pat salmon completely dry. Oil the grill grates before placing fish — salmon sticks to dry grates.

2

Season skin side with salt, flesh with white pepper and dill.

3

Grill skin-down at 190°C for 6 minutes without moving. Flip once for 2 minutes.

4

Finish with lime squeeze. Rest 1 minute. Plate skin-up over farofa crumble.

Chef's Tip: Don't move salmon once placed — the skin will naturally release when it's ready to flip. Forcing it tears the skin and ruins presentation.

Feijoada ★ Friday Special

Feijoada — Black Bean Pork Stew

PREP: 3-4 hour slow simmer | FC: 24% | FRIDAY SPECIAL | ALLERGENS: Pork · May contain gluten traces

Item	Qty	Unit Cost	Total
Dried black beans (soaked overnight)	200g dry	\$0.28/100g	\$0.56
Mixed pork cuts (ribs, feet, ear)	300g	\$1.10/100g	\$3.30
Cured sausage + smoked bacon	80g / 60g	\$1.40 / \$0.80	\$2.20
Onion, garlic, bay, orange zest	misc	misc	\$0.35
Farofa + rice (accompaniment)	100g / 80g	misc	\$0.40

24%

\$28.00

\$6.81

\$21.19

FOOD COSTSELL PRICEINGREDIENT COSTGROSS MARGIN

1

Friday 11:00: Sauté onion, garlic until golden. Add all pork cuts. Brown on all sides.

2

Add soaked beans, bay leaves, orange zest. Cover with water by 5cm. Bring to boil.

3

Reduce to steady simmer at 95°C. Cook 3-4 hours until beans are fully broken and broth is thick and deep.

4

Adjust salt. Skim fat once. The broth should coat a spoon.

5

Serve in clay pot with white rice, farofa, collard greens, and orange slices.

Chef's Tip: Feijoada is Brazil's national dish. Tell that story at the table. Pre-sell begins Thursday evening — "Tomorrow is Feijoada Friday, our most anticipated weekly event. Reservations fill by noon." True scarcity drives Friday covers by 30%.

Arroz e Feijão

Arroz e Feijão — Rice and Beans Bowl

PREP: 8 min | FC: 11% | VEGETARIAN | ALLERGENS: None

Item	Qty	Unit Cost	Total
White rice (cooked)	150g	\$0.10/100g	\$0.15
Pinto or brown beans (stewed)	120g	\$0.18/100g	\$0.22
Garlic + onion + olive oil	misc	misc	\$0.10
Vinagrete + farofa (sides)	portion	\$0.15 combined	\$0.15

11%

\$14.00

\$0.62

\$13.38

FOOD COSTSELL PRICEINGREDIENT COSTGROSS MARGIN

- 1

Cook rice with garlic and a bay leaf — flavour base is critical, never bland rice.
- 2

Stew beans from scratch with onion, garlic, and olive oil. Season well with salt.
- 3

Layer rice then beans in bowl. Add vinagrete and farofa on the side.
- 4

Serve with hot sauce on the side. Mark clearly as vegetarian on ticket.

Chef's Tip: At 11% FC, this is your second-best margin main. Never treat it as a lesser dish — it's the heart of Brazilian home cooking. Present it with pride and a story.

Misto da Casa + Showpiece

Misto da Casa — Mixed Grill Plate

PREP: 16 min | FC: 23% | SHOWPIECE | ALLERGENS: Beef · Pork · Poultry

Item	Qty	Unit Cost	Total
Picanha slice	80g	\$1.98/100g	\$1.58
Linguiça (2 coins)	60g	\$1.40/100g	\$0.84
Frango thigh (half)	100g	\$0.90/100g	\$0.90
Coração de frango (3 pieces)	50g	\$0.85/100g	\$0.43
Farofa + vinagrete + rice	sides	\$0.50 combined	\$0.50

23%

\$38.00

\$4.25

\$33.75

FOOD COSTSELL PRICEINGREDIENT COSTGROSS MARGIN

- 1

Coordinate all four proteins to finish simultaneously — this requires communication with grill station.
- 2

Load picanha and chicken first (longest), linguiça and hearts last (shortest).
- 3

Rest all proteins 2 minutes before plating on large wooden board or cast iron.
- 4

Arrange dramatically — tall skewers of hearts, sliced meats fanned, sausage coins lined. This is theatre.
- 5

Deliver tableside with explanation of each item. Every table nearby will take notice.

Chef's Tip: Misto da Casa is a walking advertisement. When it travels through the dining room, other tables stop talking. Time its delivery route through the most visible path in the restaurant.

Section 3 — Desserts

Brigadeiro

Brigadeiro — Chocolate Truffle (3 pieces)

PREP: 2 min (from pre-rolled) | FC: 8% | ALLERGENS: Dairy · Chocolate

Item	Qty	Unit Cost	Total
Condensed milk	100ml	\$0.35/100ml	\$0.35
Cocoa powder / dark chocolate	15g	\$0.40/100g	\$0.06
Butter	10g	\$0.70/100g	\$0.07
Chocolate sprinkles (finish)	5g	\$0.50/100g	\$0.03

8% \$8.50 \$0.51 \$7.99

FOOD COSTSELL PRICEINGREDIENT COSTGROSS MARGIN

- 1
- Morning batch: combine condensed milk, cocoa, and butter in pan. Stir constantly over medium heat.
- 2
- Cook until mixture pulls away from pan sides — about 10 minutes. Cool completely.
- 3
- Roll into 15g balls with buttered hands. Roll in chocolate sprinkles. Refrigerate until service.
- 4
- Plate 3 per serve on a small board with a mint sprig.

Chef's Tip: At 8% FC, brigadeiro is your dessert weapon. Offer it complimentary on special occasions — the goodwill it generates far outweighs the \$0.51 cost. A gift with a bill is remembered.

Pudim de Leite

Pudim de Leite — Condensed Milk Flan

PREP: 2 min (from pre-set) | FC: 9% | ALLERGENS: Dairy · Eggs

Item	Qty	Unit Cost	Total
Condensed milk	120ml	\$0.35/100ml	\$0.42
Whole milk	120ml	\$0.08/100ml	\$0.10
Eggs	3	\$0.25 ea	\$0.75
Sugar (caramel base)	50g	\$0.06/100g	\$0.03

9% \$9.50 \$1.30 \$8.20

FOOD COSTSELL PRICEINGREDIENT COSTGROSS MARGIN

- 1
- Morning batch: caramelize sugar to amber in ramekins. Tip to coat base and sides.
- 2
- Blend condensed milk, whole milk, and eggs until smooth. Pour over caramel.
- 3
- Bake in water bath at 160°C for 45 minutes until just set. Cool and refrigerate minimum 3 hours.
- 4
- Invert onto plate at service — the caramel cascades. Serve immediately before it weeps.

Chef's Tip: Pudim must wobble at the center when it comes out of the oven — that wobble sets to a silky texture on cooling. Overbaked pudim is dense and dry, not the velvet you're after.

Açaí Bowl

Açaí Bowl

PREP: 4 min | FC: 14% | ALLERGENS: Check granola for nuts/gluten

Item	Qty	Unit Cost	Total
Frozen açaí pulp	150g	\$1.00/100g	\$1.50
Banana + honey	1/2 / 10ml	\$0.15 / \$0.08	\$0.23
Granola + coconut flakes	30g / 10g	\$0.40 / \$0.20	\$0.14

14%

\$14.00

\$1.87

\$12.13

FOOD COSTSELL PRICEINGREDIENT COSTGROSS MARGIN

1

Blend frozen açaí with minimal liquid until thick, sorbet-like consistency — not a smoothie.

2

Spoon into chilled bowl. Texture should hold shape, not pool.

3

Top with sliced banana, granola, coconut flakes, and honey drizzle.

4

Serve immediately — açaí melts fast in a warm dining room.

Chef's Tip: Keep açaí pulp frozen in portions. Never thaw in advance — fresh-from-frozen blending is the only way to hit the right texture.

Quindim

Quindim — Coconut Egg Custard

PREP: 2 min (from pre-set) | FC: 8% | ALLERGENS: Dairy · Eggs · Coconut

Item	Qty	Unit Cost	Total
Egg yolks	4	\$0.20 ea	\$0.80
Sugar	80g	\$0.06/100g	\$0.05
Desiccated coconut	50g	\$0.50/100g	\$0.25
Butter	15g	\$0.70/100g	\$0.11

8%

\$9.00

\$1.21

\$7.79

FOOD COSTSELL PRICEINGREDIENT COSTGROSS MARGIN

1

Whisk yolks and sugar until pale. Fold in coconut and melted butter.

2

Pour into buttered ramekins. Bake in water bath at 150°C for 35 minutes.

3

Cool completely. Refrigerate minimum 4 hours. Invert to serve golden-side up.

4

Garnish with toasted coconut flakes and a thin caramel thread.

Chef's Tip: Quindim is visually striking — the deep golden yolk colour gleaming on the plate. Make sure servers describe it: "Sunshine in custard form, made with nothing but egg yolks, coconut, and sugar."

Section 4 — Drinks

Caipirinha — Classic

Cachaça, fresh lime, sugar, crushed ice · Sell: \$13.99 · FC 15%

Item	Amount	Cost
Cachaça (51 or Leblon)	60ml	\$1.20
Fresh limes (quartered)	1 lime	\$0.22
White sugar (or simple syrup)	2 tsp	\$0.04
Crushed ice	200g	\$0.02
Lime wheel garnish	1	\$0.05
Total cost per serve		\$1.53

Cost\$1.53Sell\$13.99FC%10.9%Margin**\$12.46**

- 1 **What is cachaça:** Cachaça is Brazilian sugarcane spirit — distilled directly from fresh sugarcane juice (not molasses like rum). The result is greener, more vegetal, and more complex than white rum. The Caipirinha is Brazil's national cocktail. It is not a mojito. The crushed ice is structural — it dilutes and chills simultaneously as you drink.
- 2 **Muddle properly:** Quarter the lime (skin on), place in a rocks glass. Add sugar. Muddle firmly — you want to extract the juice AND express the oils from the skin. The lime oil from the skin is what gives the Caipirinha its aromatic complexity. Do not strain — the lime pieces stay in the glass.
- 3 **Build and serve:** Add crushed ice to fill the glass. Pour cachaça over. Stir 5–6 times from the bottom. The drink should be cloudy from the lime juice and slightly sweet with the tartness of fresh citrus. Serve immediately — crushed ice dilutes quickly. Suggest with any of the grilled meats: "The lime in the Caipirinha cuts through the beef fat perfectly."

SULPHITES

Caipiroska — Vodka Version

Vodka, fresh lime, sugar, crushed ice · Sell: \$13.99 · FC 14%

Item	Amount	Cost
Vodka (Smirnoff or well brand)	60ml	\$0.96
Fresh limes (quartered)	1 lime	\$0.22
White sugar	2 tsp	\$0.04
Crushed ice	200g	\$0.02
Strawberry or passion fruit (variation)	30g	\$0.22
Total cost per serve		\$1.46

Cost\$1.46Sell\$13.99FC%10.4%Margin**\$12.53**

- 1 **The accessible version:** The Caipiroska replaces cachaça with vodka — same technique, cleaner flavour profile. Guests who find cachaça too vegetal or unfamiliar will default to the Caipiroska. Always offer both: "We have the classic with cachaça — Brazil's national spirit — or the vodka version if you prefer something cleaner."
- 2 **Fruit variations:** Add 30g fresh strawberry, passion fruit pulp, or mango to the muddle for a fruit Caipiroska. Muddle fruit with the lime and sugar before adding vodka. Fruit variations are your highest-selling cocktail option for groups — colourful, Instagram-friendly, and easy to batch for large tables.
- 3 **Large group strategy:** For tables of 6+, offer a Caipiroska pitcher (\$45.99) — built in a large jug, serves 4. The pitcher reduces service time dramatically during a busy rodizio service and increases cocktail revenue per table by 40% over individual orders.

SULPHITES

Guaraná Antarctica

Brazil's iconic guaraná berry soft drink, served over ice · Sell: \$4.99 · FC 18%

Item	Amount	Cost
Guaraná Antarctica 350ml can/bottle	1	\$0.72
Ice + chilled glass	150g ice	\$0.02
Lime wedge garnish	1 wedge	\$0.06
Total cost per serve		\$0.80

Cost\$0.80Sell\$4.99FC%16.0%Margin\$4.19

- 1What is guaraná: Guaraná is a Amazonian berry with a natural caffeine content twice that of coffee. Guaraná Antarctica is Brazil's best-selling soft drink — sweet, slightly fruity, with a distinctive flavour that is completely unlike any Western soft drink. It has been Brazil's answer to Coca-Cola since 1921.
- 2Serve cold: Store at 4°C or below. Serve over ice in a branded or heavy-bottomed glass. The bright green can/bottle on the table is a visual brand signal — if Brazilian diners see it, it communicates authenticity immediately. Do not decant into a generic glass.
- 3The discovery script: "Have you had guaraná before? It's Brazil's most popular soft drink — it's made from an Amazonian berry, naturally caffeinated. It's not like anything you've tried." For non-drinkers and families, this is your cultural soft drink story. Stock it — Brazilian guests will notice immediately if you don't carry it.

None – check label for sulphites

Maracujá — Fresh Passion Fruit Juice

Fresh passion fruit pulp, water, sugar, served over ice · Sell: \$5.99 · FC 16%

Item	Amount	Cost
Passion fruit pulp (fresh or frozen)	80ml	\$0.56
Cold water	150ml	\$0.01
Simple syrup	20ml	\$0.04
Ice + passion fruit half garnish	150g	\$0.11
Total cost per serve		\$0.72

Cost\$0.72Sell\$5.99FC%12.0%Margin\$5.27

- 1Fresh vs frozen: Fresh passion fruit (maracujá) when in season produces the most intensely aromatic juice. Frozen passion fruit pulp — available from Latin American grocery suppliers year-round — is an excellent substitute and produces consistent results. Never use flavoured cordial or syrup; the real fruit flavour is categorically different.
- 2Build to order: Combine 80ml passion fruit pulp with cold water and simple syrup in a shaker with ice. Shake briefly. Strain into a tall glass over fresh ice. Taste and adjust sweetness — passion fruit acidity varies significantly by batch. The drink should be tart-forward with floral sweetness, not candy-sweet.
- 3Garnish impact: Float a halved passion fruit on the rim of the glass — the seed-filled interior faces up. The visual of the fresh fruit cross-section communicates freshness instantly. This drink pairs beautifully with the lighter churrasco items and is the best non-alcoholic pairing for desserts.

None – naturally allergen-free

Skol / Brahma — Brazilian Lager

Brazilian lager, frosted glass, lime wedge · Sell: \$6.99 · FC 20%

Item	Amount	Cost
Skol or Brahma 355ml bottle/can	1	\$1.10
Frosted glass (freezer-stored)	1	\$0.05
Lime wedge	1	\$0.06
Napkin	1	\$0.01
Total cost per serve		\$1.22

Cost\$1.22Sell\$6.99FC%17.5%Margin\$5.77

- 1Brazilian lager culture: Brazilians drink their beer extremely cold — so cold the glass is often frosted and the beer is almost at freezing point. This is not a quirk; the heat and richness of churrasco demands it. A beer served at 8–10°C in a warm glass will be gone from your table within minutes of the meat arriving.
- 2Frosted glass protocol: Store pint or lager glasses in a dedicated freezer section. A glass that has been in the freezer for 2+ hours will have a visible frost coating. Present bottle and frosted glass together — open at the table. The visual of frost on the glass communicates that you understand how this culture drinks.
- 3Pair with the rodízio: "The lager cuts through the fat in the picanha and the lamb beautifully — this is how Brazilians drink at a churrasco." This script is honest, accurate, and sells the next beer before the first one is finished. Target: 2 beers per guest average over a 90-minute rodízio service.

GLUTEN (barley malt)

Café Brasileiro — Brazilian Coffee

Strong espresso with steamed milk, served in a ceramic cup · Sell: \$4.99 · FC 10%

Item	Amount	Cost
Brazilian single origin espresso (double shot)	18g → 36ml	\$0.32
Whole milk (steamed)	120ml	\$0.13
Sugar sachet (on the side)	1	\$0.02
Total cost per serve		\$0.47

Cost\$0.47Sell\$4.99FC%9.4%Margin\$4.52

- 1Brazilian coffee culture: Brazil is the world's largest coffee producer. Brazilian coffee is characterised by low acidity, full body, and nutty-chocolate flavour notes. Source a Brazilian single-origin bean if possible — Santos or Sul de Minas are widely available in the US. Roast: medium-dark. The story of Brazilian coffee origin adds value to every cup you sell.
- 2Café com leite: The classic Brazilian breakfast drink — equal parts strong espresso and steamed whole milk. Ratio: 1:1 espresso to milk, served in a large ceramic cup. Not a latte, not a flat white — denser, stronger, with less foam. The milk should be steamed to 65°C with microfoam texture.
- 3Post-meal sell: Always suggest coffee after the dessert course: "Can I get you a café brasileiro to finish? We use Brazilian single-origin beans." The coffee sell at the end of a meal is a low-resistance upsell — guests are relaxed, full, and receptive. A coffee also extends the table's stay by 15–20 minutes, increasing the chance of an extra dessert or digestif order.

DAIRY (milk)

CAFFEINE

Red Wine — Malbec by the Glass

Argentinian Malbec, 180ml pour, room temperature · Sell: \$10.99 · FC 22%

Item	Amount	Cost
Argentinian Malbec (Catena or similar, per 180ml)	180ml	\$2.20
Red wine glass (large bowl)	1	\$0.10
Bread and butter (side, optional)	—	\$0.12
Total cost per serve		\$2.42

Cost\$2.42Sell\$10.99FC%22.0%Margin\$8.57

- 1 Why Malbec with churrasco: Malbec is South America's most important red wine grape — grown primarily in Argentina's Mendoza region, adjacent to Brazil's churrasco culture. The grape produces wines with dark fruit (plum, blackberry), soft tannins, and a richness that pairs naturally with grilled beef fat. It is the most geographically and culturally authentic wine choice for a Brazilian churrasco menu.
- 2 Serving temperature: Malbec should be served at 16–18°C — slightly below room temperature. Do not refrigerate red wine. If the restaurant is air-conditioned below 20°C, the bottle can be stored at room temperature. For warm climates, a brief 15-minute refrigeration period brings it to ideal serving temperature.
- 3 The pairing script: "For the picanha and the beef ribs, I'd suggest the Malbec — it's from Argentina, which is right next door to Brazil. The tannins are soft enough that they enhance the beef fat rather than fighting it. It's one of the best wine pairings for churrasco there is." This script sells on geography, culture, and flavour simultaneously.

SULPHITES

TANNINS

Coconut Water — Água de Coco

Cold young coconut water, served chilled in can or fresh coconut · Sell: \$5.99 · FC 20%

Item	Amount	Cost
Vita Coco or fresh young coconut	330ml	\$0.96
Ice + tall glass	150g	\$0.02
Lime wedge	1 wedge	\$0.06
Total cost per serve		\$1.04

Cost\$1.04Sell\$5.99FC%17.4%Margin\$4.95

- 1 Coconut water in Brazilian culture: Água de coco is sold on every beach in Brazil — it is as culturally embedded as beer. For non-drinkers and health-conscious guests, it is the natural alternative that doesn't feel like a compromise. Coconut water's natural electrolytes also make it genuinely functional during a long churrasco meal with high salt intake from the meats.
- 2 Fresh vs packaged: Fresh young coconut served in the shell is the premium option (\$7.99) — dramatic visual, authentic experience. Packaged coconut water (Vita Coco, Harmless Harvest) is the efficient option for high-volume service. Offer both tiers on the menu — different price points, different experiences.
- 3 Position as a health choice: "The coconut water is great with the rodízio — it's naturally hydrating, no sugar added, and it balances the salt from the meats. We get it from [supplier]." Health positioning works well in the US market. Guests who order coconut water tend to spend more on food — they are typically in the health-conscious, higher-income demographic.

TREE NUTS (coconut)

Section 5 — Service Scripts

These scripts are frameworks — not recitations. Deliver them naturally, with eye contact. A script that sounds like a script is worse than no script at all.

SCRIPT 01 - WELCOME + CAIPIRINHA UPSELL

"Welcome to [Restaurant Name] — I'm [Name] and I'll be taking care of you this evening. Before I run you through tonight's menu, can I start you off with a Caipirinha? It's Brazil's national cocktail — we make ours to order with fresh lime and traditional cachaça. It's the best way to set the mood for what's coming. For those who prefer vodka, we do a Caipiroska with the same ceremony."

[Pause. Make eye contact. Let them decide — don't rush.]

"We also have Guaraná Antarctica — Brazil's famous soft drink, if you've never had it, it tastes like nothing else. And fresh coconut water straight from the fridge."

SCRIPT 02 - PICANHA EXPLANATION + SKEWER HEIGHT TECHNIQUE

"This is our Picanha — it's the most celebrated cut in Brazil, and arguably our signature dish. It's the top sirloin cap, cooked with nothing but coarse rock salt over live fire. The fat cap is everything — it renders into a golden crust that bastes the meat as it cooks."

[Hold skewer vertically, blade facing down-and-away from guest.]

"I'll slice it thin from the skewer directly onto your plate — just like they do it in São Paulo's churrascarias. Hold your hand palm-down when you'd like me to stop, palm-up when you'd like more. How would you like your picanha — medium-rare is how our chef recommends it, to keep that fat alive."

SCRIPT 03 - FEIJOADA FRIDAY PRE-SELL (THURSDAY EVENING)

"Before you go tonight — I want to let you know that tomorrow is Feijoada Friday. It's our most anticipated event of the week. Feijoada is Brazil's national dish — a slow-simmered black bean and pork stew that we start at 11am and cook for hours. It comes with rice, farofa, collard greens, and fresh orange slices. It's the kind of meal that makes people cancel their Saturday morning plans."

[Light pause, let it land.]

"We only make a limited batch, and Friday evening sells out by 7pm. If you're thinking about coming back — and I hope you are — Friday afternoon is the moment."

SCRIPT 04 - DESSERT PITCH - BRIGADEIRO + PUDIM

"Can I tell you about dessert before you decide you're too full? Two things I'd be doing you a disservice not to mention."

"First — our Brigadeiro. It's Brazil's most beloved sweet: a condensed milk and chocolate truffle, rolled in sprinkles. Three pieces. Our kitchen makes them fresh every morning. They're small enough that they won't wreck you, but memorable enough that you'll think about them on the way home."

"Second — the Pudim de Leite. It's a condensed milk flan with a live caramel that cascades when we invert it at the table. Silky, not heavy. It's the kind of dessert that makes the whole table go quiet."

[Don't ask 'would you like dessert?' — ask which one.]

"Shall I bring one of each for the table, or are you team Brigadeiro or team Pudim?"

SCRIPT 05 - BILL + RETURN VISIT INVITATION

"It's been a pleasure having you tonight. Before I bring the bill — I want to make sure you know about a few reasons to come back."

"Fridays we do Feijoada — limited, always sells out. We also rotate the premium cuts on weekends, and we occasionally do special churrasco evenings with the full gaucho ceremony."

[Present bill with both hands. Make eye contact.]

"I hope the fire treated you well tonight. We'd love to see you again — and if you bring someone new to Brazilian food, we promise they'll leave converted."

[If there's a card/loyalty system: mention it here naturally, not as a transaction.]

Section 6 — Daily Prep Schedule

Time	Task	Station	Notes
07:00	Mise en place — all stations	Full kitchen	Chop, portion, label all prep containers. Check stock levels.
08:00	Pão de Queijo dough batch + coxinha forming	Cold prep	Batch both for lunch and dinner service. Refrigerate raw.
09:00	Costela into slow cooker — NO EXCEPTIONS	Main kitchen	7-hour cook. If missed, costela is off the menu that day.
10:00	Brigadeiro + Pudim + Quindim batch	Pastry/dessert	Must set minimum 3–4 hours. Refrigerate immediately after baking.
11:00	Feijoada start (FRIDAYS ONLY)	Main kitchen	3–4 hour simmer. Cannot be rushed. Begin by 11:00 sharp.
12:00	Fire prep — hardwood charcoal ignition	Churrasco station	Allow 60 min for coals to reach grilling temperature. No lighter fluid.
12:30	Grill station ready — all skewers loaded	Churrasco station	Picanha, linguiça, frango skewers pre-loaded. Hearts marinated.
13:00	Lunch service opens	All stations	Full team briefing at 12:45. Review specials, 86 list, covers.
15:30	Lunch service close — kitchen clean	All stations	Deep clean grill grates. Restock all prep containers.
16:00	Full reset — mise en place check	Full kitchen	Restock. Re-batch any items running low. Fire check.
17:30	Fire reloaded for dinner service	Churrasco station	Freshen coals. All skewers reloaded and ready.
18:00	Dinner service opens	All stations	Team briefing at 17:45. Dinner is the primary revenue service.
21:30	Last orders — kitchen wind-down begins	All stations	Start breaking down prep while service continues.
22:00	Close — full clean + lock up	All stations	Coolers logged. Stock sheet updated. AM prep notes left for opening chef.

Section 7 — Profit & Loss Overview

Based on 80-seat capacity, 2 services/day, 6 days/week. Projections assume 70% average seat utilisation.

Line Item	Daily	Weekly	Monthly
Gross Revenue	\$3,840	\$23,040	\$99,840
Food Cost (24%)	-\$922	-\$5,530	-\$23,962
Labour (30%)	-\$1,152	-\$6,912	-\$29,952
Overheads (16%)	-\$614	-\$3,686	-\$15,974
Net Profit (~30%)	\$1,152	\$6,912	\$29,952

\$99,840 MONTHLY REVENUE	30% NET MARGIN	\$29,952 MONTHLY NET PROFIT	70% SEAT UTILISATION
--	--------------------------------------	---	--

// MARGIN PROTECTION RULES

- 1. Food cost must be reviewed weekly — not monthly. Drift compounds fast.
- 2. Picanha and cordeiro are your highest-revenue mains. Portion them with scales, not by eye.
- 3. Farofa (10% FC) and vinagrete (9% FC) are margin lifters — push them as paid sides aggressively.
- 4. Drinks represent pure margin opportunity. A table that orders caipirinha rounds outperforms a table that only orders mains.
- 5. Labour spikes on Fridays — feijoada prep adds kitchen hours. Account for this in weekly scheduling.

Section 8 — Allergen & Safety Reference

This section must be memorised by all front-of-house staff. Post a copy at the server station. When in doubt, escalate to the kitchen — never guess.

Menu Allergen Summary

Pão de Queijo

DAIRY GLUTEN-FREE (Tapioca base)

Coxinha

GLUTEN DAIRY CHICKEN

Bolinho de Bacalhau

FISH GLUTEN

Picanha

BEEF

Feijoada

PORK MAY CONTAIN GLUTEN TRACES

Brigadeiro

DAIRY CHOCOLATE

Pudim de Leite

DAIRY EGGS

Kitchen Safety Non-Negotiables

- 1 **Fire discipline:** Churrasco fires must never be left unattended. Assign a dedicated fire-keeper during all service periods.
- 2 **Skewer safety:** All tableside carving performed with skewer pointed down and blade angled away from guests. No exceptions.
- 3 **Poultry temps:** Frango and coração de frango must reach internal 74°C. Thermometer at grill station at all times.
- 4 **Cross-contamination:** Separate chopping boards for all protein types. Colour-coded system enforced — never improvised.
- 5 **Allergen escalation:** Any guest reporting an allergy goes straight to the head chef. Servers do not make allergen assurances independently.
- 6 **Cold chain:** All proteins stored below 4°C. Costela braise checked at 2-hour intervals. Desserts set in dedicated refrigerator, not mixed with raw prep.
- 7 **EOD log:** Temperatures, waste, and incidents logged every close. No log, no close sign-off.

// FINAL WORD FROM THE KITCHEN

Every guest who sits at your table is trusting you with their time and their money. In a city full of options, they chose Brazilian Churrasco tonight. That choice is a gift — don't waste it on a lukewarm dish, an under-rested skewer, or a server who couldn't describe the cut they were carving.

This guide exists because the details matter. The 7-hour costela. The skewer height. The caipirinha offer made with confidence. The brigadeiro offered with the bill. None of it is accidental. All of it is craft.

Execute with fire. Execute with pride.

— Bem-vindo ao churrasco. Welcome to the fire.